Ingoa / Name:	Akomanga / Class:	Rā / Date:

Place-name detectives

Relief lesson · all levels · self-directed. Follow the four steps below.

Ngā mahi · How this lesson works (60 minutes)

- *Step 1 (5 min) · Write your name. Find your level: Ara 1 = Novice 1, Ara 2 = Novice 2, Ara 3 = Novice 3. Not sure? Start at Ara 1 and keep going when you finish.*
- *Step 2 (10 min) · Read the **Ako · Learn** section below. Say the te reo words quietly to yourself or a partner.*
- *Step 3 (35 min) · Do the **Mahi** section: Parts A and B, then your Ara section, then the island design. Stuck? Look back at Ako · Learn or ask a partner.*
- *Step 4 (10 min) · Kōrero: swap sheets with a partner and decode each other's island names. Then choose a "Finished early?" task at the end.*

Ako · Learn · Step 2 (10 min): read this first

Many place names in Aotearoa are built from smaller words. If you know the parts, you can often work out the meaning. Names can also remember an event or an ancestor, so not every name translates word by word. Local iwi are the experts on the stories behind their names.

Kupu / Word bank: wai = water · roto = lake · maunga = mountain · motu = island · awa = river · nui = big · iti = small · roa = long · tapu = sacred · wera = hot · one = sand, beach · puke = hill · whanga = harbour, bay · rua = two

How to decode: worked examples

Place name	Parts	Meaning
Rotorua	roto + rua	second lake
Wainui	wai + nui	big water
Aotearoa	ao + tea + roa	long white cloud

The two main islands: Te Ika-a-Māui is the North Island. Te Waipounamu is the South Island. (Hint for Part B: three places are in each island.)

Mahi · Do · Step 3: Everyone parts first, then your Ara section

Part A · Decode the place names.

Place name	Parts	Meaning
Waiwera		
Rotoiti		
Whanganui		
Maunganui		
Motutapu		
Puketapu		
Oneroa		

Part B · Which island? Tick Te Ika-a-Māui (North) or Te Waipounamu (South).

Place	Te Ika-a-Māui	Te Waipounamu
Rotorua		
Kaikōura		
Taupō		
Ōtautahi		
Whanganui		
Aoraki		

Ara 1 · Write the te reo word.

1. water _____
2. lake _____
3. mountain _____
4. island _____
5. big _____
6. small _____
7. hot _____

Ara 2 · Sentence starters

- *Kei Te Ika-a-Māui a Rotorua. (Rotorua is in the North Island.)*
- *Kei Te Waipounamu a Kaikōura. (Kaikōura is in the South Island.)*
- *He roto nui a Taupō. (Taupō is a big lake.)*

Ara 2 · Write three sentences in te reo about places in Aotearoa, using the starters.

Ara 3 · Invent a te reo name for a place at school (the field, library, canteen …) using the word parts. Explain it in te reo: Ko … te ingoa, nā te mea he …

Everyone: design an imaginary island. Draw it and give six places te reo names made from the word parts (e.g. Rotoroa = long lake).

Finished early? *Write the English meaning beside each of your island names · Find three more Māori place names you know and try to decode them · Write a sentence about your island: He motu ātaahua a …*